Cleveland Browns Offense: Scouting Report

Public data. Built from nflverse (nflfastR play-by-play, NGS participation, FTN charting), mapped onto the PFF GamePBP layout. Run concepts, PFF success codes, yards after contact and receiver alignment are not in this source; see *What nflverse cannot cover* at the end.

Sample: 9 games (Sep 13, 2026 to Nov 08, 2026) · 527 offensive plays · Opponents: BLT, CAR, JAX, NO, NYJ, PIT, TB, TEN
Source: CLV_2026_nflverse_GamePBP.csv · Generated Nov 10, 2026 18:07 · Success = standard yardage definition · EPA = nflfastR model

65%	56%	-0.10	44%	35%
PASS RATE	NEUTRAL EARLY-DOWN PASS RATE	EPA / PLAY	SUCCESS RATE	3RD-DOWN CONVERSION

10%	8%
SACK RATE	EXPLOSIVE PLAY RATE

Key findings

TENDENCIES

- Passes on 65% of all plays and 56% of neutral early-down plays (1st/2nd down, outside 2-minute drills).
- QB alignment is a strong run/pass key: under center they run 73% of the time (n=114); in shotgun they pass 78% (n=395).
- Pistol is a real part of the menu: 18 plays, 6% pass.
- Tell: 3rd Down + Long (7-10) → pass 97% of the time (n=36, 95% lower bound 86%).
- Tell: 3rd Down + Medium (4-6) → pass 97% of the time (n=35, 95% lower bound 85%).
- Tell: Shotgun + 3rd Down → pass 89% of the time (n=108, 95% lower bound 82%).
- Tell: Pistol → run 94% of the time (n=18, 95% lower bound 74%).
- Run game is built on Middle and Left End: 40% of carries.
- Predictability: knowing personnel, alignment, down and distance lifts a defense's run/pass guess from 65% to 77% (leave-one-out).

STRENGTHS

- Most efficient run gap: Right End, +0.03 EPA/carry, 5.1 YPC, 39% success (n=18).
- Primary target: D. Boston (#12) (WR), 21% target share, 30 catches for 448 yards, +0.06 EPA/target, 19 first downs.
- Most efficient receiver: I. Bond (#0) (WR), +0.39 EPA/target on 9 targets, aDOT 13.3, 3.8 YAC/rec.
- Lead back Q. Judkins (#10): 60% of carries, 3.3 YPC, 43% success. Favorite gap: Middle.
- Most total value: H. Fannin Jr. (#44), 17.8 total EPA on 53 touches + targets (453 scrimmage yards).
- Deep shots (20+ air yards): 10% of targets, 36% complete, +0.55 EPA/target (n=28).

VULNERABILITIES

- Play action: 17% of dropbacks, -0.15 EPA/play vs -0.00 without (n=57 vs 285).
- Least efficient run gap: Left Guard, -0.31 EPA/carry, stuffed (0 or fewer yards) on 33% (n=24).
- On 3rd and Extra Long (11+) they convert only 5% (n=22); they pass 91% of the time there. Overall 3rd-down conversion: 35%.
- High-volume, low-return target: J. Jeudy (#3) (WR), 10% of targets but +0.01 EPA/target and 64% catch rate.

n = the number of plays (or carries / targets) behind a number, i.e. the sample size. Findings are generated by fixed rules (see Methodology) and include sample sizes. Treat any rate built on fewer than 10 plays as anecdotal.

1. Personnel run/pass tendencies

No plays to chart

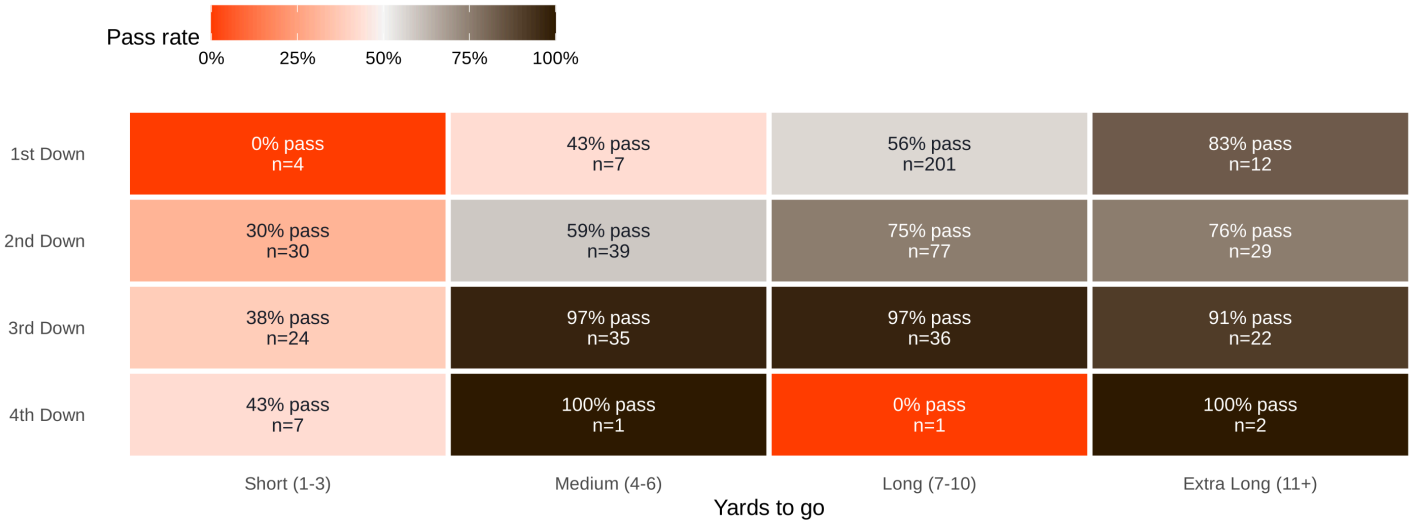
Not available for this data set.

527 plays with no recorded personnel are left out of this section.

2. Down-and-distance tendencies

Pass rate by down and distance

Each box: share of plays that were passes, and n = number of plays in that down-and-distance situation



Data: nflverse (nflfastR pbp, NGS participation, FTN charting)

Down	To go	Plays	Pass %	Run EPA	Pass EPA	Success
1st Down	Short (1-3)	4	0%	-0.68	n/a	25%
1st Down	Medium (4-6)	7	43%	+0.69	+0.07	71%
1st Down	Long (7-10)	201	56%	-0.05	+0.16	50%
1st Down	Extra Long (11+)	12	83%	-0.05	-0.08	33%
2nd Down	Short (1-3)	30	30%	-0.27	+0.01	57%
2nd Down	Medium (4-6)	39	59%	-0.26	-0.22	51%
2nd Down	Long (7-10)	77	75%	-0.56	-0.06	39%
2nd Down	Extra Long (11+)	29	76%	-0.04	-0.28	31%
3rd Down	Short (1-3)	24	38%	-0.21	+0.95	62%
3rd Down	Medium (4-6)	35	97%	+0.18	+0.34	51%
3rd Down	Long (7-10)	36	97%	-1.28	-0.38	19%
3rd Down	Extra Long (11+)	22	91%	-0.61	-0.73	5%
4th Down	Short (1-3)	7	43%	-1.81	+1.41	43%
4th Down	Medium (4-6)	1	100%	n/a	-3.15	0%
4th Down	Long (7-10)	1	0%	-4.14	n/a	0%
4th Down	Extra Long (11+)	2	100%	n/a	-2.57	0%

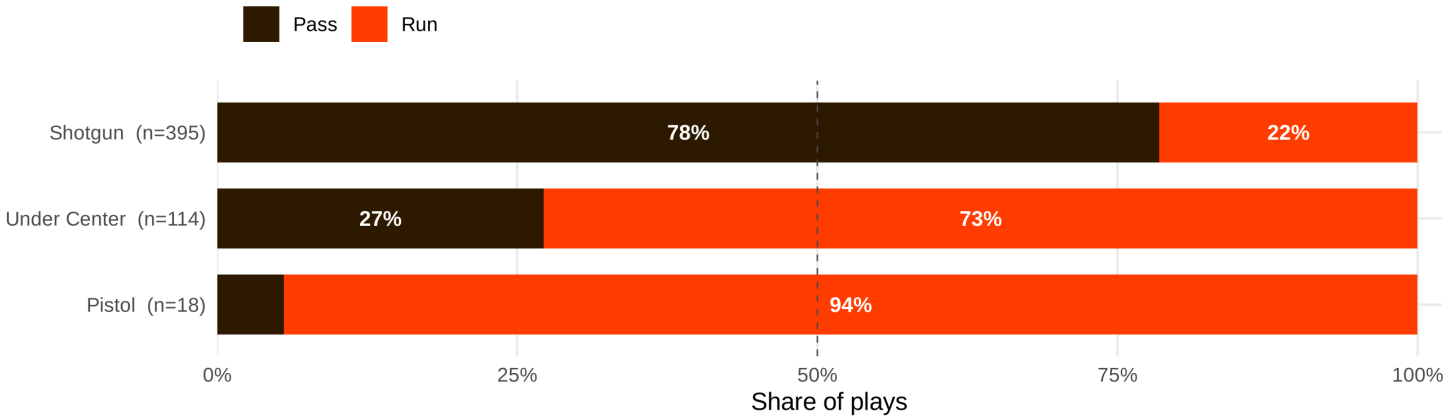
By field position (yards from the opponent's end zone):

Zone	Plays	Pass %	EPA/play	Success
Goal to Go (1-10)	31	48%	-0.23	42%
Red Zone (11-20)	31	58%	-0.15	52%
Plus Territory (21-50)	154	69%	-0.13	40%
Own Territory (51-80)	240	71%	-0.02	45%
Backed Up (81-99)	71	45%	-0.23	44%

3. QB alignment tendencies

Run/pass split by QB alignment

n = number of plays from that alignment; read small groups with caution



Data: nflverse (nflfastR pbp, NGS participation, FTN charting)

Alignment	Plays	Snap %	Pass %	Run EPA	Pass EPA	Run YPC	Pass Y/P
Under Center	114	22%	27%	-0.33	-0.22	2.9	5.5
Shotgun	395	75%	78%	-0.17	-0.01	4.1	5.9
Pistol	18	3%	6%	-0.03	-0.33	3.5	1.0

Alignment by personnel (groupings with enough plays):

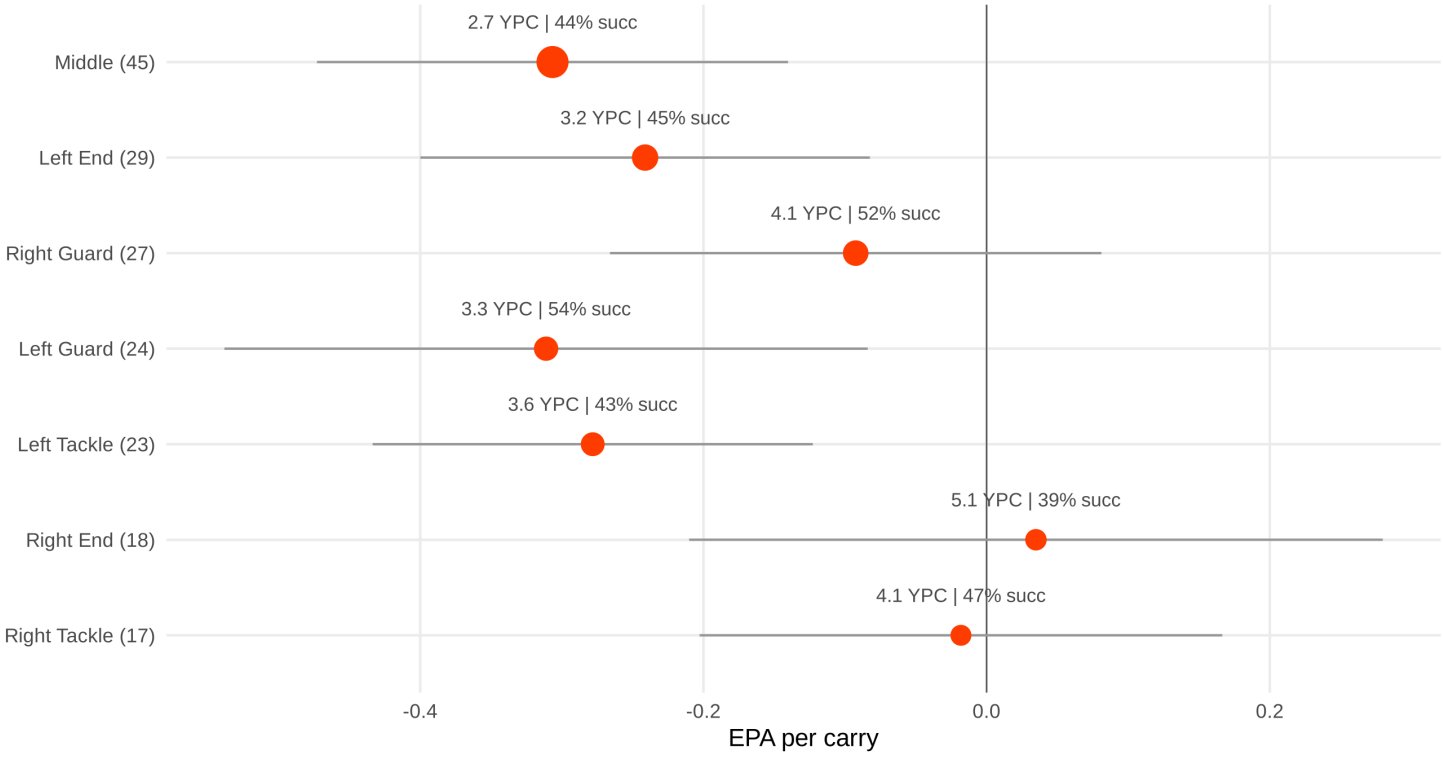
Not available for this data set.

4. Run gap and direction: frequency and effectiveness

nflverse does not chart blocking schemes, so runs are grouped by the gap and side the play-by-play records (end / tackle / guard / middle). This answers *where* they run, not *which concept*.

Run gap and direction: volume and efficiency

Ordered by carries (in brackets). Point = EPA per carry, bar = +/- 1 standard error



Data: nflverse (nflfastR pbp, NGS participation, FTN charting)

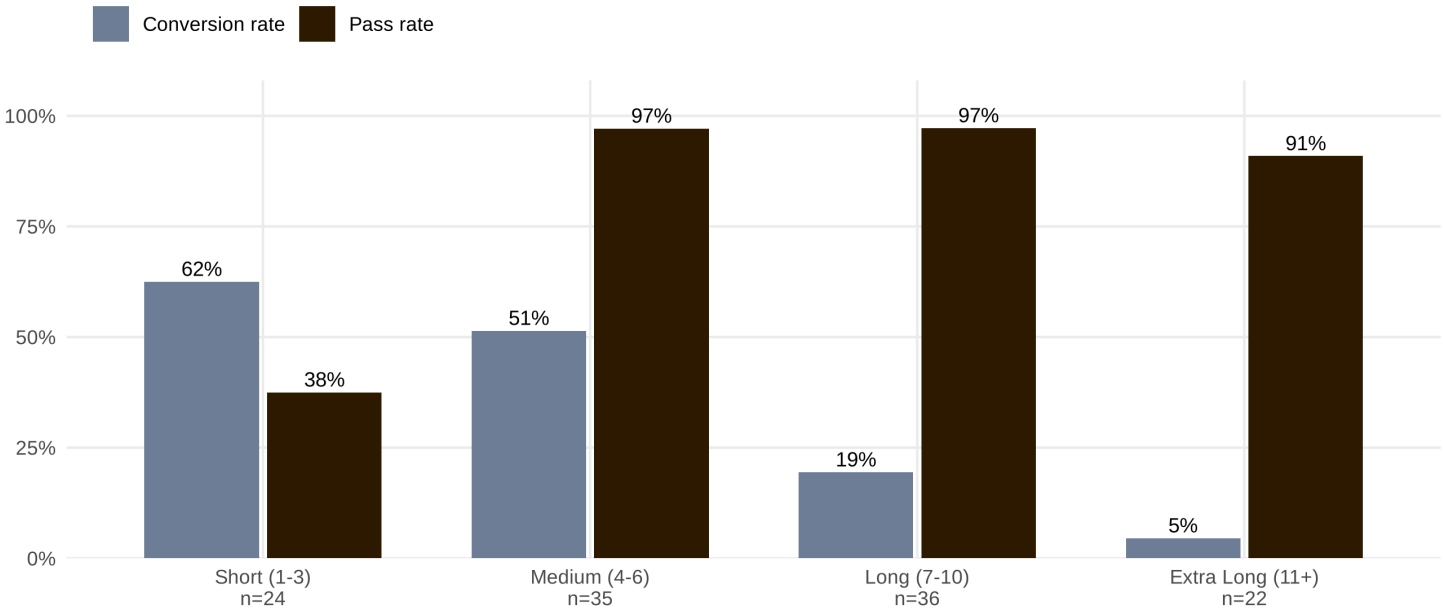
Concept	Carries	Share	YPC	Median	Success	EPA/carry	Stuff %	Explosive %	Under center %	Top personnel
Middle	45	24%	2.7	3.0	44%	-0.31	16%	0%	47%	Unknown
Left End	29	16%	3.2	2.0	45%	-0.24	24%	7%	45%	Unknown
Right Guard	27	15%	4.1	3.0	52%	-0.09	11%	7%	44%	Unknown
Left Guard	24	13%	3.3	3.5	54%	-0.31	33%	8%	42%	Unknown
Left Tackle	23	12%	3.6	2.0	43%	-0.28	26%	4%	70%	Unknown
Right End	18	10%	5.1	2.5	39%	+0.03	33%	17%	33%	Unknown
Right Tackle	17	9%	4.1	3.0	47%	-0.02	12%	6%	24%	Unknown

2 carries with no charted run gap are left out of this table.

5. Third-down behavior and key targets

Third down: how often they throw and how often they convert

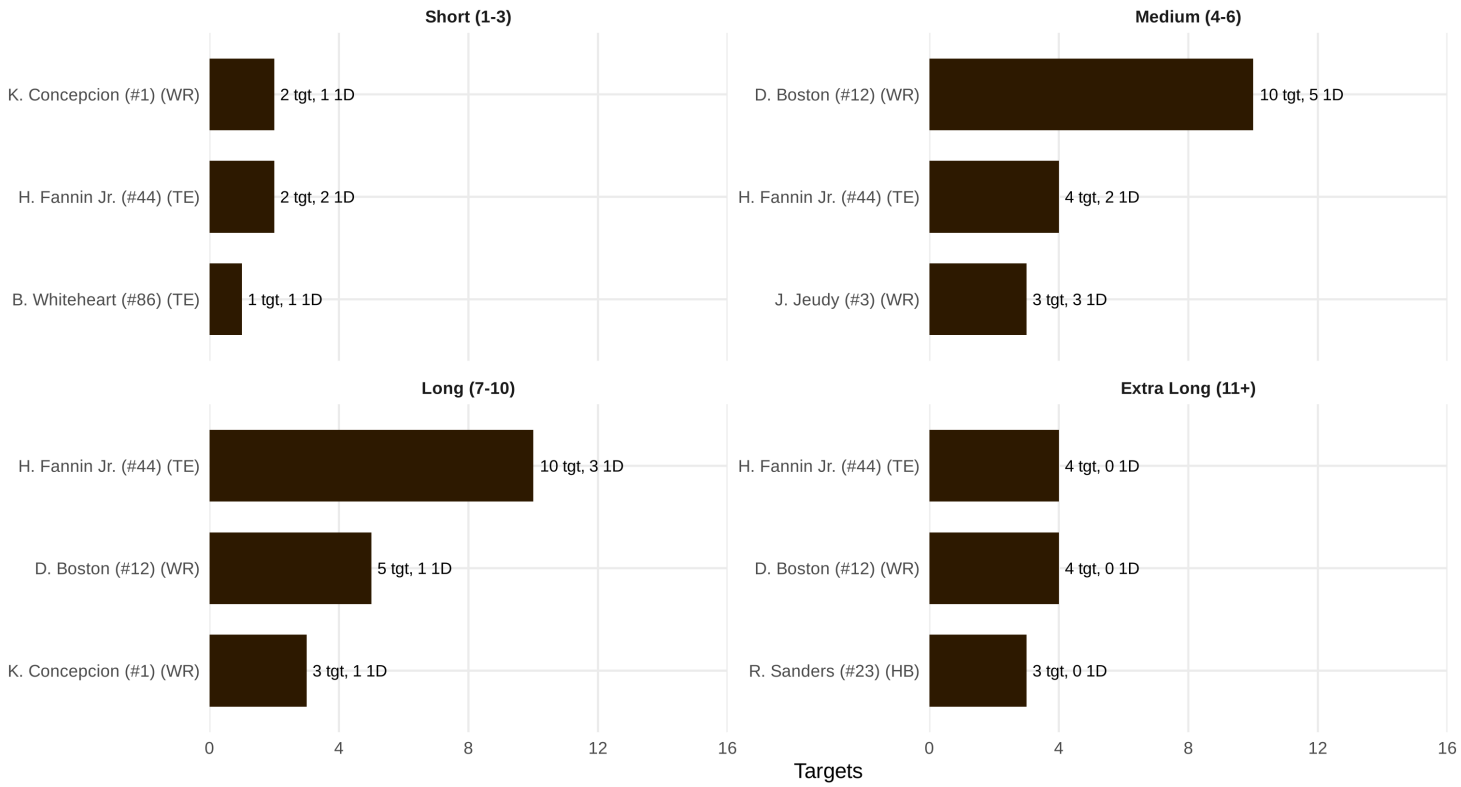
n = number of third-down plays at that distance



Data: nflverse (nflfastR pbp, NGS participation, FTN charting)

To go	Plays	Pass %	Conv %	Conv 95% CI	EPA/play	Gun/Pistol %	Avg air yds	Sack %
Short (1-3)	24	38%	62%	43%-79%	+0.23	75%	4.3	0%
Medium (4-6)	35	97%	51%	36%-67%	+0.33	97%	9.3	9%
Long (7-10)	36	97%	19%	10%-35%	-0.40	100%	9.2	14%
Extra Long (11+)	22	91%	5%	1%-22%	-0.72	91%	11.7	15%

Third-down target leaders by distance



1D = first downs gained on those targets. Data: nflverse (nflfastR pbp, NGS participation, FTN charting)

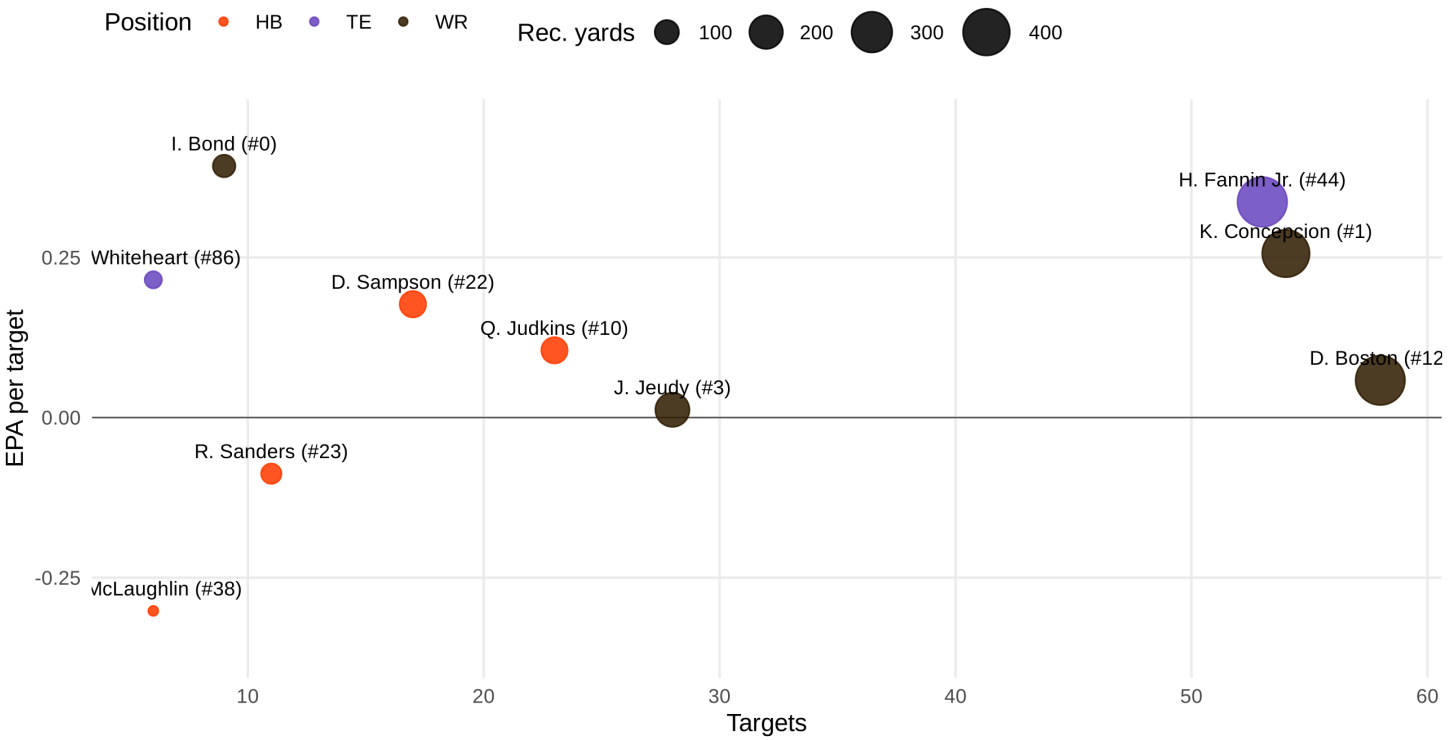
All third downs

Player	Pos	Targets	Share	Rec	Yds	1st downs	EPA/tgt	aDOT
D. Boston (#12)	WR	20	29%	8	83	7	-0.16	14.9
H. Fannin Jr. (#44)	TE	20	29%	12	159	7	+0.09	8.3
K. Concepcion (#1)	WR	10	14%	5	76	3	+0.07	9.9
R. Sanders (#23)	HB	6	9%	5	32	1	-0.30	-0.8
J. Jeudy (#3)	WR	4	6%	3	76	3	+1.37	18.2
D. Sampson (#22)	HB	3	4%	2	38	2	+1.33	-1.7
I. Bond (#0)	WR	3	4%	2	22	1	+0.38	6.3
B. Whiteheart (#86)	TE	1	1%	1	17	1	+3.06	3.0

6. Most effective players and how they produce

Receiving volume vs. efficiency

Players with at least 5 targets

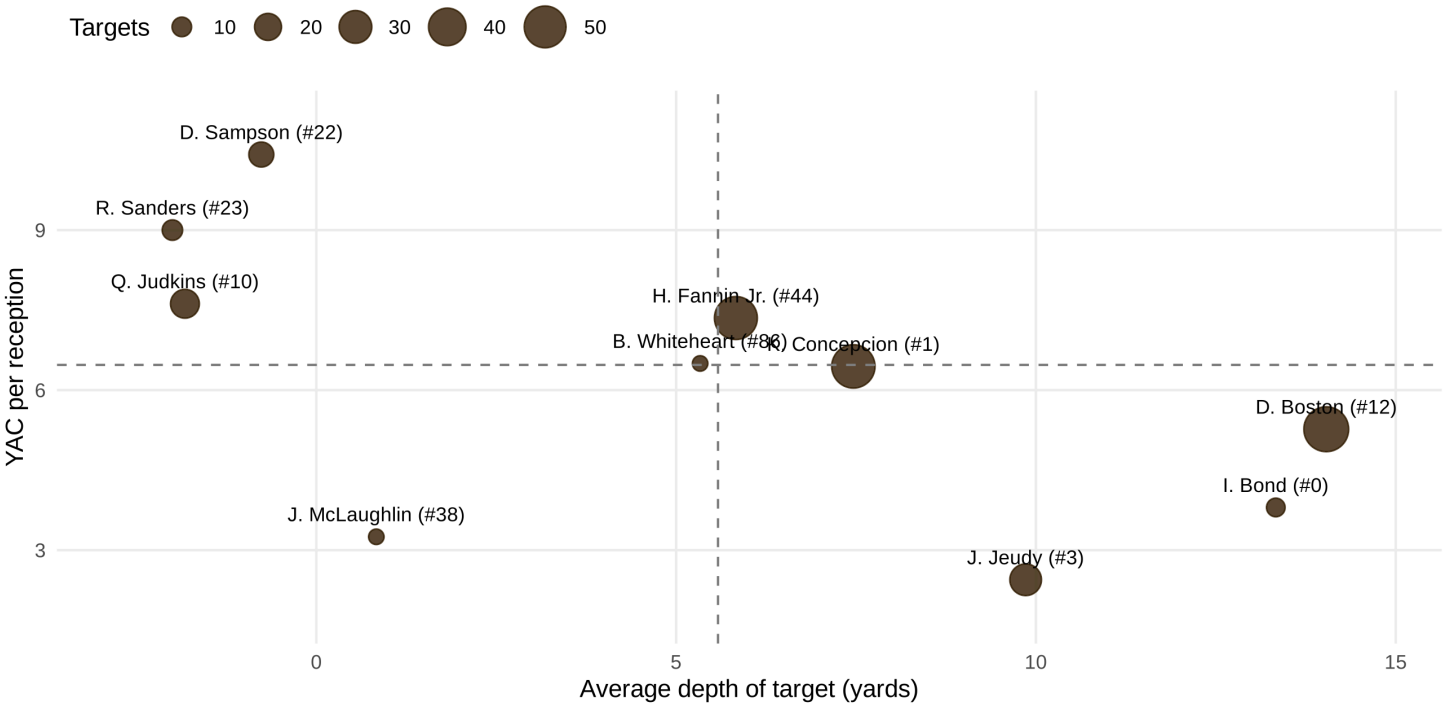


Data: nflverse (nflfastR pbp, NGS participation, FTN charting)

Player	Pos	Tgt	Share	Rec	Yds	Catch %	Y/Tgt	aDOT	YAC/Rec	EPA/Tgt	1D
D. Boston (#12)	WR	58	21%	30	448	52%	7.7	14.0	5.3	+0.06	19
K. Concepcion (#1)	WR	54	20%	36	412	67%	7.6	7.5	6.4	+0.26	17
H. Fannin Jr. (#44)	TE	53	20%	37	453	70%	8.5	5.8	7.4	+0.34	20
J. Jeudy (#3)	WR	28	10%	18	208	64%	7.4	9.9	2.4	+0.01	11
Q. Judkins (#10)	HB	23	8%	21	120	91%	5.2	-1.8	7.6	+0.10	5
D. Sampson (#22)	HB	17	6%	12	121	71%	7.1	-0.8	10.4	+0.18	7
R. Sanders (#23)	HB	11	4%	10	69	91%	6.3	-2.0	9.0	-0.09	3
I. Bond (#0)	WR	9	3%	5	86	56%	9.6	13.3	3.8	+0.39	4
B. Whiteheart (#86)	TE	6	2%	4	48	67%	8.0	5.3	6.5	+0.22	2
J. McLaughlin (#38)	HB	6	2%	4	14	67%	2.3	0.8	3.2	-0.30	0
T. Wallace (#16)	WR	3	1%	3	21	100%	7.0	0.0	7.0	+0.14	1
M. Burton (#34)	HB	2	1%	0	0	0%	0.0	0.0	n/a	-0.66	0

How receivers produce: depth of target vs. yards after catch

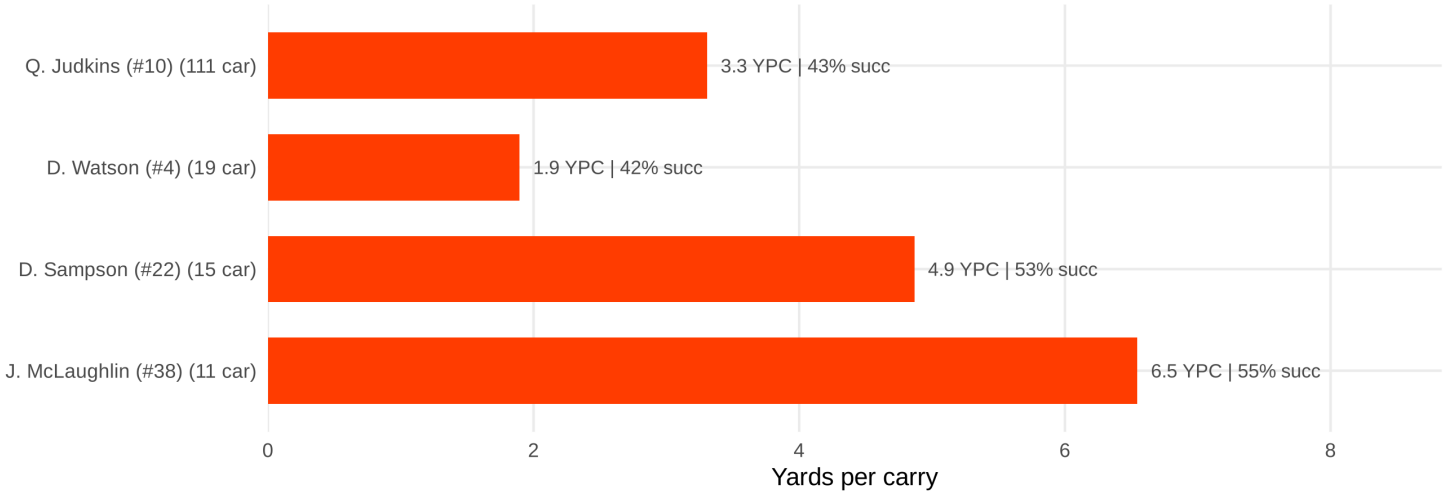
Right = targeted deeper downfield; up = more yards after the catch. Dashed = team medians



Data: nflverse (nflfastR pbp, NGS participation, FTN charting)

Rushers: yards per carry

Yards after contact is not in this data source, so carries are not split



Data: nflverse (nflfastR pbp, NGS participation, FTN charting)

Player	Carries	Share	Yds	YPC	Success	EPA/car	YBC	YACo	Explosive %	Stuff %	Top concept
Q. Judkins (#10)	111	60%	367	3.3	43%	-0.26	n/a	n/a	6%	23%	Middle
D. Watson (#4)	19	10%	36	1.9	42%	-0.46	n/a	n/a	0%	37%	Middle
D. Sampson (#22)	15	8%	73	4.9	53%	-0.08	n/a	n/a	7%	13%	Left End
J. McLaughlin (#38)	11	6%	72	6.5	55%	+0.24	n/a	n/a	9%	9%	Left Tackle
A. Estim<U+00E9> (#30)	9	5%	19	2.1	56%	-0.12	n/a	n/a	0%	33%	Left Tackle
K. Concepcion (#1)	8	4%	30	3.8	62%	-0.37	n/a	n/a	12%	25%	Left End
R. Sanders (#23)	8	4%	42	5.2	38%	+0.07	n/a	n/a	12%	0%	Right Guard
S. Sanders (#2)	2	1%	5	2.5	50%	-0.60	n/a	n/a	0%	0%	Middle

Total offensive value (rushing + receiving EPA; QB passing EPA is credited to targets):

Player	Carries	Targets	Scrimmage yds	Rush EPA	Rec EPA	Total EPA	EPA/opp
H. Fannin Jr. (#44)	0	53	453	0.0	17.8	17.8	+0.34
K. Concepcion (#1)	8	54	442	-2.9	13.8	10.9	+0.18
I. Bond (#0)	0	9	86	0.0	3.5	3.5	+0.39
D. Boston (#12)	0	58	448	0.0	3.4	3.4	+0.06
D. Sampson (#22)	15	17	194	-1.2	3.0	1.8	+0.06
B. Whiteheart (#86)	0	6	48	0.0	1.3	1.3	+0.22
J. McLaughlin (#38)	11	6	86	2.6	-1.8	0.8	+0.05
M. Burton (#34)	1	2	2	2.1	-1.3	0.8	+0.26

7. Passing-game context

Split	Value	Dropbacks	Share	EPA/play	Success	Y/P
Play action	No	285	83%	-0.00	44%	6.1
Play action	Yes	57	17%	-0.15	39%	4.7
Screen	No	303	89%	-0.03	43%	5.8
Screen	Yes	39	11%	-0.02	44%	5.7

Targets by depth

Depth	Targets	Share	Comp %	Y/Tgt	EPA/Tgt	INT %
Behind LOS	74	27%	76%	5.1	-0.11	0%
Short (1-9)	129	48%	74%	6.7	+0.15	2%
Intermediate (10-19)	40	15%	48%	9.4	+0.37	0%
Deep (20+)	28	10%	36%	13.6	+0.55	4%

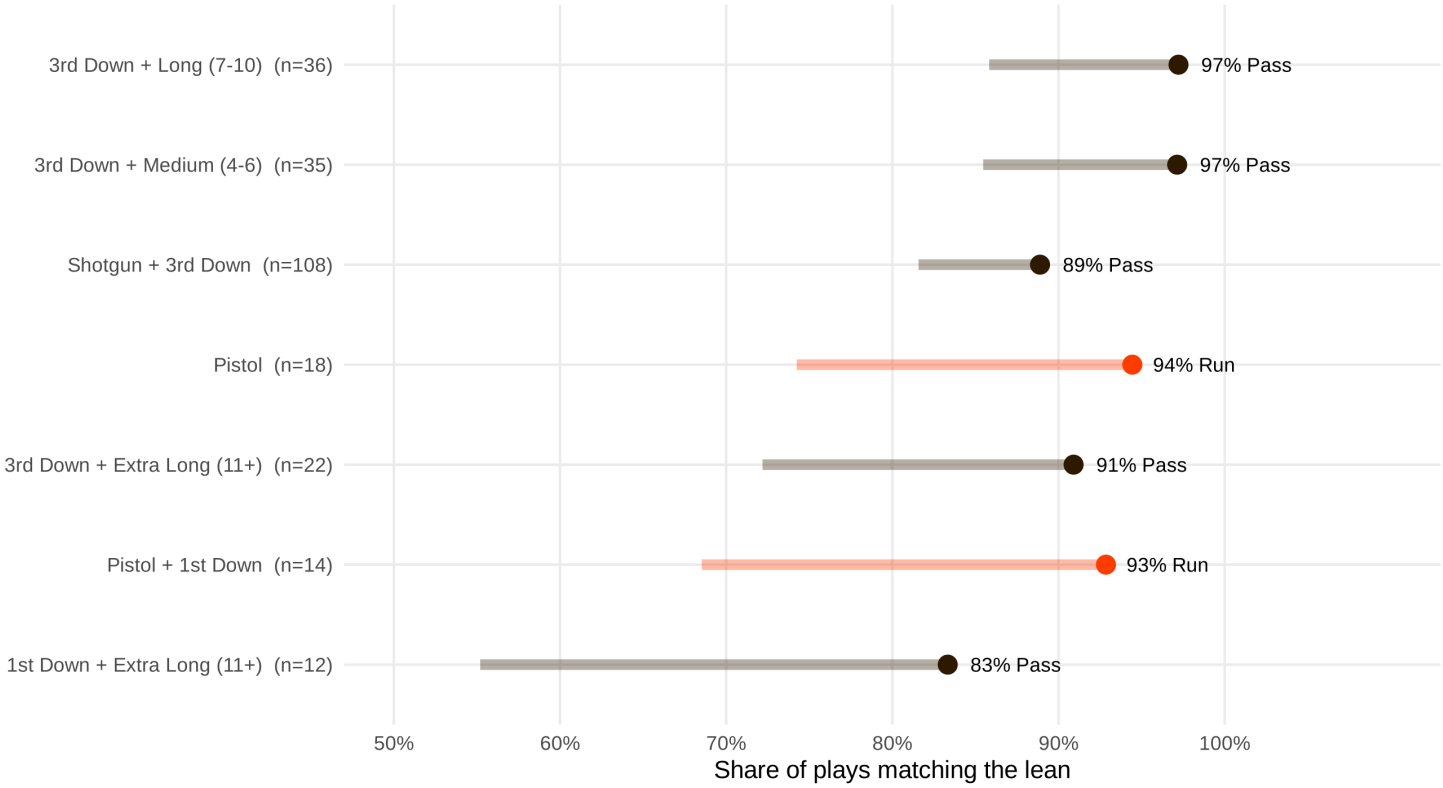
Results by defensive coverage faced (5+ dropbacks)

Coverage	Dropbacks	Share	EPA/play	Success
Unknown	342	100%	-0.03	43%

8. Pre-snap tells and predictability

Strongest pre-snap tells

Dot = observed rate; faded bar runs down to the 95% lower bound; n = plays with that cue



Data: nflverse (nflfastR pbp, NGS participation, FTN charting)

Always guessing the more common play type is right **65%** of the time. Using personnel, alignment, down and distance bucket (leave-one-out cell rates) is right **77%** of the time, a lift of **12%**.

Methodology and data notes

How the sample was built

Step	Plays
Offensive snaps in file	613
Run or pass plays (drops penalties / no-plays)	554
Downs 1-4 (drops PATs / 2-pt tries)	554
Excluding garbage time	536
Excluding QB kneels and spikes	527

WHAT NFLVERSE CANNOT COVER (OR ONLY APPROXIMATES)

- Personnel / formation / coverage / routes: nflverse participation data covers only 0% of these plays (it is typically posted after the season), so those sections are mostly empty.
- Run concepts: nflverse has no blocking-scheme charting (inside zone, duo, power ...). Section 4 groups runs by gap and direction instead (e.g. 'Left Tackle', 'Middle').
- PFF success codes (pff_OFFSUCCESS): not in nflverse. Success uses the standard 40/60/100 yardage rule only.
- EPA / EP: nflfastR's public model, not PFF's. Values are close in spirit but not identical.
- Yards after contact: not in nflverse, so the before/after-contact split for rushers is unavailable (yards per carry is shown instead).
- Receiver alignment (slot / wide / backfield): not in nflverse. 'Main align' is blank.
- Personnel is counted from the roster positions of the 11 players on the field (RB+FB, TE). A WR listed as TE on the roster counts as a TE. '(*)' = 6+ offensive linemen.
- Garbage time is approximated with win probability (second half, pre-snap WP below 0.01% or above 99.99%). Calibrated against a licensed PFF sample.
- 2-minute flag: inside the final 2:00 of either half (PFF's 4-minute flag has no equivalent).
- Pressure is NGS 'was_pressure' (yes/no); time to pressure is not available.

Column names below refer to the PFF GamePBP layout the nflverse data was mapped onto.

- **Pass play / dropback:** `pff_RUNPASS = "P"`, which includes sacks and QB scrambles. **Run:** `"R"`. Penalties and no-plays (`"X"`) are removed.
- **QB alignment:** Pistol if `pff_PISTOL` is set, otherwise Shotgun if `pff_SHOTGUN` is set, otherwise Under Center.
- **Success (standard):** gaining at least 40% of the distance on 1st down, 60% on 2nd, and 100% on 3rd/4th, or earning a first down. PFF success codes are not in nflverse, so only the standard rule is used.
- **First down:** `pff_FIRSTDOWNGAINED = 1` or yards gained ≥ distance.
- **EPA:** `pff_EXPECTEDPOINTSADDED` as provided. Passing EPA is attributed to the targeted receiver.
- **Target:** a pass play with a recorded receiver, excluding sacks and scrambles. **Receiving yards:** yards gained on completions.
- **Explosive:** runs of 10+ yards, passes of 20+ yards.
- **Field zone:** `ABSOLUTEYARDLINE` is yards to the opponent's end zone (so 1–20 is the red zone).
- **Tell:** a pre-snap cue (personnel, alignment, down, distance, or combinations) with at least 10 plays where one play type reaches 80%. The 95% lower bound uses a Wilson interval.
- **Intervals:** rates show 95% Wilson intervals; run-concept EPA shows ±1 standard error. With samples this small, most differences between groups are not statistically distinguishable; the report shows n everywhere so readers can judge.
- **Garbage time** excluded: TRUE. **2-minute drills** excluded: FALSE. **Personnel "(*)"** marks a jumbo package (an extra offensive lineman replaces a skill player); merged into the base grouping: FALSE.

Data checks:

- Player names from CLV_2026_roster.csv (nflverse weekly rosters 2026)

Blank numeric cells (for example yards after catch on runs) are expected and listed for completeness.

Reproducibility: source file MD5 2d2f7e7c92651d1cb2e4e0de0232634a. Every table in this report is also saved as CSV and in one Excel workbook next to this file.